

intersect is much more powerful than just ANDing basic queries. It can be applied to an already ‘*intersect-ed*’ query, and so on. This means, *intersect* can be used for a query like:

```
(My Friends (People who live in Delhi (Friends of ((People who live in Bengaluru) and (like Open Source ForYou))))))
```

This kind of query seems impossible to put in a search bar. But if you are aware of the REST APIs, it just requires putting the right syntax with the right identifiers, and voila!

Some other RESTful APIs that may be of interest are listed below.

APIs related to places (Delhi, Bengaluru, etc)

```
place_id/places-near
place_id /places-in
place_id /visitors
user_id/places-visited
place_id/home-residents
place_id/users-checked-in
place_id/residents-near/present/
```

APIs for the logged-in user

```
me/non-friends/friends/
me/relatives
```

Examples of filtering based on the date

```
dec/2013/date-2/photos
may/2013/date-2/photos
2014/date/photos
```

And some more...

```
language_id/speakers
position_id/job/employees/
organization_id/employees
group_id/members
location_id/employer-location/employees
```

Useful scenarios of Facebook searches with RESTful APIs

To explore pages you may like: Suppose you want results of the query “Pages that are similar to the pages liked by people who like pages liked by me but are not my friends.”

The equivalent RESTful API is:

```
www.facebook.com/search/me/pages-liked/likers/me/non-friends/
intersect/pages-liked/pages-similar-to
```

To search for people with common interests in another city: Suppose you need to search for: “People who live in the city you are going to move to (let’s say Bengaluru) and who were born in January 1995.”

The equivalent RESTful API is:

```
www.facebook.com/search/me/pages-liked/
likers/106377336067638/residents/present/intersect/jan/1995/
date-2/users-born/intersect
```

But don’t overload Facebook servers

Each filter using this API can lead either to narrowing down the search to a few options or may include infinitely large volumes of data that make it very difficult for Facebook servers to process. In the example above, by just appending some filters as shown below the query seems to take more than 1-2 minutes to load, and sometimes doesn’t even provide any results.

```
https://www.facebook.com/search/me/pages-liked/
likers/106377336067638/residents/present/intersect/jan/1995/
date-2/users-born/intersect/pages-recommended-for/pages-
similar-to
```

Facebook’s REST APIs provide a lot of opportunities to use social networks for your benefit. A brief set of exposed APIs has been discussed here but further exploration can certainly help one in multiple ways – from identifying potential users to creating a business model-based Facebook search to provide analytics. In future releases, Facebook is planning to extend this search to posts, which will bring up some more interesting use cases.

Disclaimer

All the above Facebook objects are used for illustration purposes only. The information shared is not exhaustive, and may need revisions based on changes made by Facebook from time to time. 

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